Marae Protocol

THE 10 STAGES OF POHIRI (OR POWHIRI)

1. Ko Nga Tangata (The People)
If there are no people, than there can be no pohiri. There are two groups required for a Pohiri to commence, TangataWhenua (hosts) and Manuhiri (visitors). The minimum number required for a Pohiri is 4. Two males and two females. One female to do the karanga (call) and one male to do the mihi (speech) on either side.

2. Inoi (Prayer)
An inoi is said to ensure the safety of the people and to ensure that all stages are carried out without disturbance. An inoi should be said by both Manuhiri and Tangata Whenua.

3. Wero (Challange)
Although wero are not often seen on a regular basis today, traditionally these were carried out to ascertain the intentions of the visiting group. Wero were executed by the fastest and fittest male warriors of the Tangata Whenua. Dependant on the way in which the taki (dart) was placed down and picked up, would deem whether the Manuhiri had come in peace, or with warlike intentions.

4. Karanga (Call)
The karanga is the first voice to be heard in pohiri. The karanga is traditionally carried out by a female elder. The caller for the Tangata Whenua holds the title of kai karanga and is the first to call. The caller who replies for the Manuhiri holds the title of Kai whakatu. The purpose of the karanga is to weave a spiritual rope allowing safe passage for the Manuhiri to enter onto Te Marae nui atea o Tumatauenga (courtyard in front of the Whare Tupuna (Ancestral House).

5. Haka Pohiri (Welcome Dance)
The Haka Powhiri is executed by the Tangata Whenua. The purpose of the Haka Powhiri is to pull the waka of the Manuhiri onto the Marae atea with the rope that was woven during the karanga and to uplift the mana (prestige) of the Tangata Whenua, their marae, iwi, hapu and their tupuna (ancestors).

6. Mihi (Speeches)
Traditionally only the experts in the art of Whaikorero (Oratory) would stand to speak to the opposite group. The purpose of the mihi is to acknowledge and weave together the past, present and future, by acknowledging the creator, guardians, the hunga mate (the dead], the hunga ora (the living - those present at the powhiri) and laying down the take or kaupapa (the reason) for the Powhiri or event that will take place.

7. Oriori - Waiata (Chant - Song)
The purpose of the Oriori is to show that the people support the speaker and what he has said. Oriori often compliment what has been said, the occasion surrounding the pohiri, acknowledge the speakers whakapapa (genealogy) or the group itself.

8. Koha (Gift)
Koha is given by the Manuhiri to the Tangata Whenua. The koha is laid by the last speaker of the Manuhiri to indicate that they have no more speakers and have finished. The koha is the first contact between the Tangata Whenua and the Manuhiri. Traditionally koha were in the form of precious materials - pounamu, whale bone etc, korowai (cloaks) and numerous other taonga. Delicacies were also gifted. In today's society money is the normal form of koha. The purpose of the koha is to help with the upkeep of the marae and to cover general running costs associated with pohiri and hui. The size of the koha show the mana of the Manuhiri.

9. Hongi (Traditional Form of Greeting)
The hongi is the first physical contact between the two groups. It is not the widely popularised 'Rubbing of Noses' but the gentle pressing of nose and forehead.

10. Kai (Food)
This is the final stage of the pohiri. It is the stage where the tapu of the pohiri is removed by the sharing of kai. The tangata whenua and the manuhiri are now one.

MARAE, WHARE HUI AND WHARE KAI PROTOCOL

These rules are intended as a guide only as each area, and each Marae has its own rules. These rules are based on Classical Maori. If you know the Classical Maori Rules, the chances of you offending people are less than if you only know the modern rules.

The area immediately in front of the meeting house is to be kept clear at all times.

Alcohol is not permitted on or near the marae. Some marae apply this rule to all functions, including weddings etc. Others again are open to a request for permission to provide alcohol at social events.

Tikanga dictates normally that the right-hand side of the meeting house (the ancestors right hand) is to be occupied by the tangata whenua, while the manuhiri occupy the left-hand side including the rear and then positions left vacant by the tangata whenua.

WHARE HUI (Meeting House)

1. Do not wear shoes in the Whare Hui
2. Do not smoke in the Whare Hui
3. Do not eat kai (food) in the Whare Hui
4. Do not drink in the Whare Hui
5. Do not run around inside the Whare Hui
6. Do not walk over peoples legs, ask them to move them
7. Do not walk in front of a speaker
8. Do not drink in the Whare Hui
9. Do not chew gum
10. Do not sit on pillows ANYWHERE

WHARE KAI (Dining Room)

1. Do not sit on the tables ANYWHERE
2. Do not smoke in the Whare Kai
3. Do not throw food AT ALL
4. Do not pass food over anyones head

And, to support our kaikorero (speaker) the following is an easily learnt song.

EHARA

Ehara I te mea
No inaianei te aroha
No nga tipuna
Tuku iho, tuku iho